

AFRL DETER / TACTICAL / RAD - v2-0 Evaluation Criteria Defined



		DEFINITION
TECHNICAL MERIT - OVERALL SCIENCE / TECHNICAL MERIT <i>weight 30%</i>	PROBLEM BEING SOLVED	What is the problem being solved or the capability gap being addressed for AFRL with the proposed solution? Demonstrate the depth of your understanding of the problem's components and stakeholders.
	SOLUTION / PRODUCT SUMMARY	Write a clear, concise description of your product or solution. Succinctly explain what your product or solution is and how it addresses the problem statement/capability gap. Provide the reviewers with a clear sense of the solution you are proposing, specifically highlighting all proposed deliverables.
	DEGREE OF INNOVATION	Describe what's innovative about your approach. How big of a departure from the state-of-the-art is your solution?
	RISK MITIGATION	Identify the primary drivers of technical, schedule and cost risk, along with the proposed methods to reduce or mitigate them.
	ENABLING TECHNOLOGIES	Do the required enabling technologies introduce added risk? Using mature or proven underlying technologies and techniques helps to lower technical risk.
	ALTERNATIVE TECHNICAL APPROACHES	Convince a skeptical audience that yours is the best solution from a technical perspective. Your case is strongest when you convincingly refute the alternatives.
	RELEVANT EXPERIENCE	Describe your relevant experience with similar work and/or with similar technologies. Explain how your previous work with relevant projects makes you an ideal candidate to accomplish the proposed solution.
TECHNICAL MERIT - SOUNDNESS OF TECH. APPROACH <i>weight 30%</i>	SCIENTIFIC FEASIBILITY	Is the science behind the solution sound? Convince readers who don't have deep expertise in your field that your innovation is built atop sound scientific and engineering principles. Point to the foundational and proven technologies that you rely on to deliver your solution.
	TECHNICAL PERSONNEL	Briefly list and describe your core scientific and technical team. Do you have the people and technical capabilities you need to successfully complete your proposed project? If not, convince the reader you have a credible recruiting plan and can fill personnel gaps.
	TECHNICAL FACILITIES & RESOURCES	Briefly list and describe your technical facilities and resources. Do you have the resources and technical facilities you need to successfully complete your proposed project? If not, convince the reader you have a credible plan to attain the necessary facilities or resources to accomplish the proposed solution.
	APPROPRIATENESS OF MEASUREMENT	List the key performance indicators (KPIs) or technical performance measures (TPMs) that are most appropriate to measure your progress with this project. Prove these metrics are the most appropriate possible measurements of success for a project such as this one.
	REASONABLE SCHEDULE	Provide a schedule for the proposed solution. The provided schedule should be realistic and reasonable for the proposed technical solution. It should include thoughtfully considered milestones.
IMPORTANCE / RELEVANCE TO AFRL PROGRAMS <i>weight 20%</i>	SOLUTION ALIGNMENT	Map your solution logically to one or more Topic Area(s). Does your solution directly addresses one or more research thrust identified within the Topic Area(s)?
	IMPACT TO MISSION	Define the impact or benefits gained with your proposed solution. Specify contributions to AFRL's research and development within the Topic Area.
	VALUE OF CONTRIBUTION	The proposed solution provides meaningful contributions which outweighs the risks.
VALUE / COST <i>weight 20%</i>	RELIABLE COST ESTIMATE	Provide cost estimates that are complete, realistic and credible. Support them with verifiable data or analysis.
	PROPOSED VALUE	The benefit or impact of the proposed solution appropriately outweighs the costs.
	FUNDING AVAILABILITY	If your proposal is of sufficiently high quality, our team will have to determine if it can realistically be funded with our available budget. If your proposal is on the high end of the budget guidelines, please do your best to identify partners from whom additional funding may be available.

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		UNSATISFACTORY	MARGINAL	SATISFACTORY	SUPERIOR
TECHNICAL MERIT - OVERALL SCIENCE / TECHNICAL MERIT	PROBLEM BEING SOLVED	Undefined problem scope.	Somewhat defined problem scope.	Adequately defined problem scope.	Very well defined problem scope.
	SOLUTION / PRODUCT SUMMARY	Fails to describe intended solution.	Partly describes intended solution.	Adequately describes intended solution.	Clearly describes intended solution.
	DEGREE OF INNOVATION	No departure from existing technological approaches.	Slight departure from existing technological approaches.	Significant departure from existing technological approaches.	Radical departure from existing technological approaches.
	RISK MITIGATION	Incomplete or incoherent risk and mitigation discussion.	Incomplete risk analysis. Inadequate mitigation plans.	Adequate risk analysis. Reasonable mitigation plans.	Thorough risk analysis. Credible mitigation plans.
	ENABLING TECHNOLOGIES	Relies on nonexistent or unavailable technology.	Relies on emerging, cutting edge technology.	Relies on proven technologies.	Relies on commercially available or fielded technologies.
	ALTERNATIVE TECHNICAL APPROACHES	No examination of alternatives.	Partially refutes alternatives.	Adequately refutes alternatives.	Persuasively refutes alternatives.
	RELEVANT EXPERIENCE	Lacks experience with relevant technology.	Indirect experience supporting relevant projects.	Direct experience completing relevant projects.	Direct experience successfully completing relevant projects.
weight 30%					
TECHNICAL MERIT - SOUNDNESS OF TECH. APPROACH	SCIENTIFIC FEASIBILITY	No scientific basis for presented approach.	Incomplete scientific basis for presented approach.	Credible scientific basis for presented approach.	Convincing scientific basis for presented approach.
	TECHNICAL PERSONNEL	Existing team lacks essential personnel. Gaps are high risk.	Existing team lacks important personnel. Evolving plan for gaps.	Existing team is high quality and nearly complete. Credible plan for gaps.	Existing team is impressive and complete. No unresolved gaps.
	TECHNICAL FACILITIES & RESOURCES	Existing facilities and resources insufficient. Gaps are high risk.	Existing facilities and resources partially sufficient. Evolving plan for gaps.	Existing facilities and resources mostly sufficient. Credible plan for gaps.	Existing facilities and resources certainly sufficient. No unresolved gaps.
	APPROPRIATENESS OF MEASUREMENT	Fails to measure indicators of impact.	Poor measurement of indicators of impact.	Adequate measurement of indicators of impact.	Highly appropriate measurement of indicators of impact.
	REASONABLE SCHEDULE	Unclear or non-credible project milestones, or timing.	Fairly clear, credible project milestones and timing. Mostly appropriate level of detail.	Mostly clear, credible project milestones and timing. Appropriate level of detail.	Completely clear, credible project milestones and timing. Appropriate level of detail.
weight 30%					
IMPORTANCE / RELEVANCE TO AFRL PROGRAMS	SOLUTION ALIGNMENT	Not aligned with any of the Topic Areas.	Somewhat aligned with at least 1 of the Topic Areas.	Aligned with at least 1 of the Topic Areas.	Perfectly aligned with at least 1 of the Topic Areas.
	IMPACT TO MISSION	If successful, no improvement vs. existing technological approaches.	If successful, slight improvement vs. existing technological approaches.	If successful, significant improvement vs. existing technological approaches.	If successful, radical improvement vs. existing technological approaches.
	VALUE OF CONTRIBUTION	Expected contributions do not outweigh risks.	Expected contributions may outweigh risks.	Expected contributions outweigh risks.	Expected contributions substantially outweigh risks.
weight 20%					
VALUE / COST	RELIABLE COST ESTIMATE	Incomplete cost estimates.	Unrealistic cost estimates.	Credible cost estimates.	Convincing cost estimates.
	PROPOSED VALUE	Expected pay-off does not out-weigh proposed cost.	Expected pay-off may out-weigh proposed cost.	Expected pay-off out-weighs proposed cost.	Expected pay-off substantially out-weighs proposed cost.
	FUNDING AVAILABILITY	Estimated cost exceeds available budget.	Estimated cost is within range of available budget.	Estimated cost is within available budget.	Estimated cost is well within available budget.
weight 20%					